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THE CONFRONTATION — Shooting Script (Final)

🎬 **Logline.** A wounded man — once a beautiful, boyish soul — metamorphosed into the Joker by a brutal love, is confronted on a stone floor by the woman he worshipped. He fires at everything but her, weeps without ever weeping, and takes his own life as the final punishment: she must watch the man she loved die.

Casting & reference anchors

- **Jack — pre-paint (Prelude):** the boyish Tobey-Maguire face. Soft, beautiful, gentle, brown hair, the shy grin. Bare. No paint.
- **Jack — the Joker (Confrontation):** the Heath Ledger Joker. Chalk-white greasepaint, blackened sunken eyes, red carved Glasgow smile, stringy green-tinted hair, purple wool overcoat, olive-green waistcoat, teal tie.
- **Julie:** platinum blonde, hair swept up, fair, luminous, austere. The reference locks her **face and identity, not a costume** — her wardrobe changes per shot as the scene calls for it. In the confrontation she's grounded: **pants and a top, never a gown.**
- **The metamorphosis rule:** the paint is not makeup. His *face itself* was consumed and remade — the beautiful boy devoured, becoming the Joker. The crossing beat morphs the boyish face into the painted one. That transformation is the emotional hinge of the film.

Visual & continuity rules (non-negotiable)

- **One location:** a stone pillar and stone floor, night. He is slumped against the pillar, on the floor, unable to stand — he fires *from the floor*.
- **Dry.** No flood, no water, no corridors. No "search" scenes — they were never in the story.
- **Tears roll constantly — he never weeps.** He speaks and laughs through them.
- **The gun never points at Julie.** He fires everywhere else; whenever she reaches to touch him, he aims away.
- **The suicide is the climax — non-graphic.** No gore, no wound detail, no blood on camera. Cut on the gesture and on her face.
- **Paint continuity:** bare boyish face (beats 1–3) → metamorphosis (beat 4) → full Joker paint, never removed (beats 5–21).
- **Costume is per-shot — common sense.** Reference images lock face/identity only; wardrobe changes with each scene. Jack's Joker look (purple coat, green waistcoat) holds through the one-night confrontation; his pre-paint clothes are ordinary and vary across the prelude memories; Julie's outfit fits each moment.

PRELUDE — 16s · Jack (VO)

1 · pro_alone — *4s*

On screen: The boyish young man, small and unnoticed, alone in a vast dim room. A thin shaft of light. No one turns to look at him. Bare face.

Jack (VO): "Before the paint, there was only a thin, quiet man no one ever turned to look at."

2 · pro_seen — *4s*

On screen: Julie — blonde, in pants and a top — turns and actually looks at him. Warm light falls; she seems to descend like an angel.

Jack (VO): "Then one person looked, and saw a mind worth keeping. She came down like an angel, descending."

Chorus (whisper): "He should have called her a woman, not a goddess."

3 · pro_silence — *4s*

On screen: The boyish man watching her from a reverent distance, eyes lowered, the word never spoken. Years pass in the light on his face.

Jack (VO): "For years I worshipped her and never said the word — certain a goddess would fall if I reached."

Chorus (whisper): "So he shut his eyes, and called it love."

4 · pro_crossing — *4s*

On screen: Midnight. Everything falls dark. The boyish face **dissolves and reforms into the Joker** — skin becoming greasepaint, the smile tearing open. A metamorphosis, not a mask. A cruel unseen laugh.

Jack (VO): "Then it all went dark. At midnight something laughed — and the man never came back."

Chorus (whisper): "Not treatment. Not a bandage. A metamorphosis."

CONFRONTATION — 83s

Full Joker paint throughout. Slumped against the pillar, on the floor. Julie stands over him.

5 · confr_caught — Julie · *5s*

On screen: Julie stands over the slumped, painted Jack; she catches his gaze drifting backward.

Julie: "There. You drifted just now — I saw it. Just once, in your own words: name the thing that hurts you. So I know which blade I'm holding."

6 · confr_allblades — Jack · *7s*

On screen: Jack, hand pressed to his side, breath shallow, a bitter grin.

Jack: "Drifting? You caught me. That's the funny part — I read every room, every face, and you're still the one thing that catches me looking backward. You don't want a weapon, my dear. You want to know if there's a man left in here soft enough to be worth the knife. So sit down. I won't hand you one blade — I'll give you all of them."

7 · confr_dare — Julie · *4s*

Julie: "You've burned the whole world. So what stops you at me? Do it. Come on — do it."

8 · confr_dontouch — Jack · *5s*

On screen: She reaches for him; he flinches and swings the gun away from her.

Jack: "Don't. Don't touch it. I hate that hand more than I hate you — a healing hand is only the wound, in disguise."

9 · confr_whomade — Jack · *6s*

Jack: "You want to know who made the Joker? You did, my dear — your brutal love. I lay there bleeding, and you never came. Give me back my twenty years."

Chorus (whisper): "She was the wound, and the hand that made it."

10 · confr_blood — Jack · *4s*

On screen: He gestures at himself — no gore shown, only the painted smile.

Jack: "You see the wounds now? This isn't blood. It's laughter — the mirror, held up to your face."

11 · confr_ect — Jack · *5s*

Jack: "They ran the lightning in, night after night. It took the grief, the face, the boy. It left this — the thing that laughs."

Chorus (whisper): "The lightning took the man and left the laugh."

12 · confr_sayit — Julie · *4s*

Julie: "You can't pull that trigger. Because you still love me. Say it — tell me you still love me."

13 · confr_aim — Jack · *4s*

Jack: "Everyone else I could burn and feel nothing. You, I can't even aim at. That's the real joke."

14 · confr_real — Jack · *4s*

Jack: "And the love was real. Every second of it. It just never reached the morning after."

15 · confr_putdown — Julie · *4s*

Julie: "It was never your face. It was us. Put it down. Please — it's not too late."

16 · confr_reachfire — Jack · *4s*

On screen: She steps closer; he fires past her, striking everything but her.

Jack: "Come closer and watch me miss. I can hit anything in this room — anything but you."

17 · confr_treatment — Julie · *5s*

Julie: "I'm not asking you to forgive me. I'm asking you to let me get you to a surgeon — now, tonight. Let them close it. You can hate me from a hospital bed. Just don't die on this floor."

18 · confr_lightning — Jack · *6s*

Jack: "Treatment. You'd hand me back to their table. You forget — the last time medicine 'healed' me, the lightning took the man and left this. No. I won't let their hands finish the job. The only treatment left for me… is the one I give myself."

19 · confr_smile — Jack · *5s*

On screen: Tears cut clean lines through the greasepaint. He never sobs.

Jack: "You're crying now? I won't let you wash that guilt off so cheaply. Here — let me put a smile on it instead."

Chorus (whisper): "What the world cannot hold, it tries to erase."

20 · confr_lastlaugh — Jack · *6s*

On screen: He turns the gun on himself. Non-graphic — hold on his eyes and the painted smile; cut on the gesture.

Jack: "One last trick, on the house. You wanted the man you loved? Then keep your eyes on me — and watch him die. This is my last laugh."

21 · confr_fall — Chorus · *5s*

On screen: Julie's face. The painted man is gone. Darkness closes.

Chorus: "The last laugh, the last punishment — she watched the man she loved die."

Voice direction — wounded lion (every Jack line)

A weakened baritone that still commands — *a lion still roaring with a wound.* Grasping, shallow breath; air gathered mid-sentence. A laugh that **costs** him — breaking into a wince or gasp. Quiet-forward on the tender beats; surge-then-collapse on the loud ones. Throughout: hand pressed to his side, chest working for air, slumped against the pillar, firing from the floor.

Runtime: Prelude 16s + Confrontation 83s ≈ **99s · 21 beats.**